ASSESSMENT OF LOSS — HURRICANE PERIA (2021)

Arden Emergency Management Agency, in conjunction with the Insurance Commissioner

1. The event

Hurricane Peria made landfall on the Arden coast in 2021, with sustained winds of 131 miles per hour at landfall and a storm surge of 12.3 feet at the tide gauge at Ardenport. 16 counties were included in the declaration. Peak outage affected 480,827 customers.

2. Assessed gross loss

The Agency's assessed gross loss is $780 million. The assessment covers damage to residential and commercial structures and contents, to public infrastructure, and to state assets, together with debris management and emergency protective measures. It is a gross figure: it is not reduced by insurance recoveries or by federal assistance, and the Agency's practice is to state it that way so that the several recovery streams can be reconciled against it separately.

Category	Assessed loss ($M)
Residential structures and contents	307.3
Commercial structures and contents	146.6
Public infrastructure	142.7
State assets	50.7
Debris and protective measures	76.4
Total (as assessed)	780

Category figures are the Agency's allocation and are rounded; the total is the assessed figure and governs. Individual categories may not sum exactly to it.

3. Recovery streams

Insured losses paid are reported by the Insurance Commissioner and federal assistance by the relevant federal agency. Neither is netted here. The reconciliation of gross loss against the recovery streams is in the separate computation in this volume.

4. Unrepaired damage

The Agency's field survey identified 948 structures in the declared counties that remain unrepaired or only partly repaired. The Agency has not assigned a value to the unrepaired portion and does not consider its survey a sufficient basis for doing so.

5. Methodology

Structure and contents loss is assessed by field inspection of a stratified sample and extrapolated to the affected parcel population using the Assessment Division's parcel records. Public infrastructure is assessed on the repair estimates of the responsible authority, adjusted to a common price date. State assets are assessed on replacement cost less depreciation. Debris and protective measures are actual expenditure. The Agency does not include loss of business revenue, loss of use, or diminution in value of undamaged property; nor does it include the cost of measures taken to prevent future loss.

Sampling: 959 parcels were inspected, being 2.2 per cent of the affected population. The Agency's standing methodology targets a sampling error of not more than ten per cent at the county level; the achieved error on this event was 7.8 per cent.

6. Revisions to this assessment

Version	Date	Assessed loss ($M)	Reason for revision
Preliminary	within 30 days	589.7	field survey incomplete
First revision	within 90 days	709.0	public infrastructure estimates received
Second revision	within 180 days	763.6	state asset valuations completed
Final	this assessment	780	claims and projects closed

Users citing an earlier version should note that the figures are not comparable: the preliminary figure omits categories rather than estimating them low.

7. Distribution of loss by county

County	Parcels affected	Assessed loss ($M)	Share of event (%)
Ardenport	6,919	142.0	18.2
Tarnmouth	6,151	154.4	19.8
Shalcombe	6,958	93.6	12.0
Eastcliff	8,446	100.6	12.9
Grayhaven	5,179	85.0	11.0
Fenwick Isle	6,005	28.9	3.7
All other counties	4,060	162.2	20.8

County figures are the Agency's allocation and are rounded; they will not sum exactly to the event total, which includes state assets and infrastructure not attributable to a single county.

8. Limitations

This assessment measures loss. It does not attribute the event to any cause, apportion responsibility, or express any view on whether the loss was avoidable. The Agency has been asked on occasion to certify that a given proportion of an event is attributable to climate change; it declines such requests, which are outside its competence.

Assessments are prepared under the Agency's standing methodology and are revised as claims and projects close. This is the final assessment for this event.